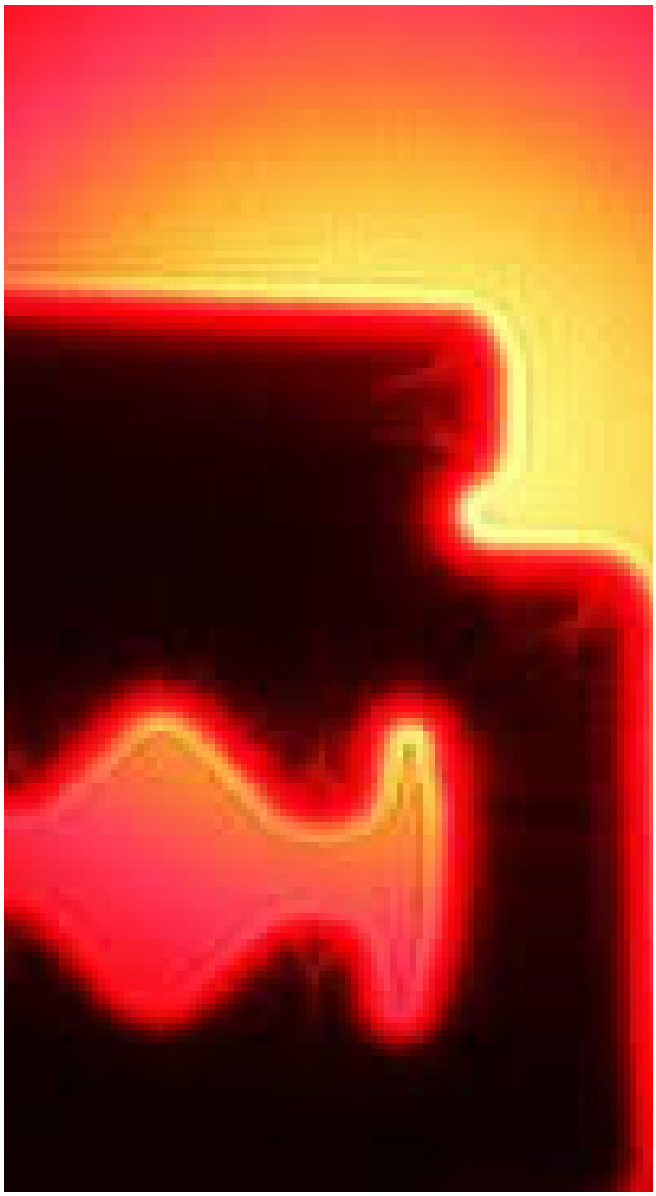
AT THE EDGE OF LIGHT.



A NEW PLAY WRITTEN AND DIRECTED BY JULIAN MERCER.

PRESENTED BY BLACK LANTERN THEATRE COMPANY

MARCH 21–23, 2026

THE ALDERWOOD STUDIO THEATRE TORONTO, ONTARIO

"WE DO NOT DESCEND TO BE LOST — WE DESCEND TO REMEMBER."

- SOCIAL MEDIA AND ADDITIONAL INFO

CONTACT DETAILS

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AWARDS AND CITATIONS

2012 EL DORADO THEATER GUILD AWARDS
Best Director | Cheese Please

2017 BEECHTOWN THEATER CRITICS CIRCLE
Best Artistic Director | Your Best Vet

2013 TOP BILL CRITICS CHOICE AWARDS
Best Play | The Law According to Cunningham and Curtis

2014 MARQUEE GUILD AWARDS
Best Musical | The Story of Schneider and Co.

2016 STAGE STAR AWARDS
Best New Play | All Smiles at Beechtown High,

Julian Mercer

Born in Halifax, Nova Scotia, Julian Mercer began writing poetry at age fourteen after spending long winters reading mythology and philosophy. Raised by a single mother who worked night shifts as a nurse, Mercer often describes theatre as the place where he first felt "language become alive."

He studied dramatic literature at McGill University before completing his MFA in Directing at the National Theatre School of Canada. His early works explored grief, religious symbolism, and psychological descent — often drawing on themes of transformation and rebirth.

Mercer's breakthrough production, The Quiet Between Waves (2019), earned him critical recognition for blending minimal staging with emotionally intense monologues. His directing style emphasizes physical stillness, symbolic lighting, and emotionally charged silence.

At the Edge of Light marks his most ambitious work to date — a story that merges mythology, memory, and modern identity. Mercer both wrote and directed this production to preserve what he calls the play's "internal rhythm — the pulse beneath the dialogue."

Director's Note

This play began with a question:
What if the descent into darkness is not failure — but initiation?

The characters in this story are not heroes. They are ordinary people standing at moments of rupture. My hope is that audiences leave not with answers, but with recognition.

— Julian Mercer

Creative Team

Playwright & Director – Julian Mercer

Associate Director – Lila Bennett

Dramaturg – Marcus Ellery

Intimacy Coordinator – Tessa Nguyen

Fight Choreographer – Aaron Kovacs

Design Team

Scenic Designer – Thomas Boudreau

Thomas is a Toronto-based scenic designer known for minimalist environments that emphasize negative space and architectural symbolism. His recent credits include The Quiet Between Waves and Echo Chamber. He specializes in modular stage structures that transform throughout the performance.

Lighting Designer – Arjun Patel

Arjun's work focuses on psychological lighting — using shadow, silhouette, and controlled warmth to guide audience emotion. He trained at Ryerson Theatre School and has designed over 30 independent productions across Ontario.

Sound Designer & Composer – Monica Reyes

Monica creates immersive sonic landscapes using layered ambient recordings and subtle tonal shifts. For At the Edge of Light, she composed an original atmospheric score built around breath, distant echoes, and fractured piano motifs.

Costume Designer – Elena Markovic

Elena blends contemporary realism with symbolic detailing. In this production, costume tones shift gradually from structured, muted fabrics to softer, more fluid materials to reflect internal transformation.

Projection Designer – Gabriel Moretti

Gabriel integrates abstract visuals and text fragments to create memory sequences that unfold across layered scrims and surfaces.

Management Team

Executive Producer – Claire Donovan

Claire oversees season programming, budget development, and community partnerships. She has worked with emerging theatre companies across Canada for over a decade.

Production Manager – Daniel Cho

Coordinates technical schedules, crew communication, and installation logistics.

Stage Manager – Maya Robinson

Leads rehearsals, calls cues during performances, and ensures continuity between departments.

Assistant Stage Manager – Carter Hughes

Supports backstage operations and actor transitions.

Technical Director – Benjamin Clarke

Supervises set construction, lighting installation, and all technical safety standards.

House Manager – Sofia Alvarez

Box Office Manager – Rachel Kim

Marketing & Public Relations – Noah Laurent

Graphic Designer (Program & Posters) – Amira Salim

Social Media Coordinator – Ethan Brooks

Cast of Characters

Elias Ward – Nathaniel Brooks
A historian wrestling with memory, regret, and buried childhood truths.
Mara Vale – Sofia Alvarez
Elias's wife, pragmatic yet quietly searching for meaning beyond routine.
The Archivist – Daniel Cho
A mysterious guide who appears at pivotal moments in Elias's descent.
Young Elias – Carter Hughes
A memory made flesh; curious, observant, and emotionally unguarded.
Voice in the Dark – Isabelle Laurent
An unseen presence representing intuition, memory, and confrontation.

Cast Bios

Nathaniel Brooks
Nathaniel is a graduate of the University of Toronto's Theatre & Performance program. Previous credits include Hamlet(Horatio), The Glass Menagerie (Tom), and Waiting for Godot (Estragon).
Sofia Alvarez
Sofia trained at the National Theatre School of Canada. She specializes in emotionally intimate roles and contemporary drama.
Daniel Cho
Daniel is both an actor and production manager based in Toronto. His recent performances include The Seafarer and A Streetcar Named Desire.
Carter Hughes
Carter is making his professional stage debut. He studies classical voice and movement and hopes to pursue acting full-time.
Isabelle Laurent
Isabelle's voice work spans theatre, radio drama, and short film narration. She views this role as "a whisper the audience already knows."

Special Note from the Company

Theatre is an act of collective risk. Every performance is temporary — built from light, breath, and presence.
We invite you not just to watch this story, but to recognize where it echoes within your own.
Thank you for sharing this space with us.

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